

Solana Trading Terminal — API Cost Breakdown

Competitive analysis vs GMGN.ai / Axiom / Padre · Generated March 2026

TIER 1 **Hobby / Solo Dev** — Testing only

SERVICE	PLAN	MONTHLY	DAILY
Helius RPC	Free	\$0	\$0
Birdeye	Free	\$0	\$0
GoPlus Security	Free	\$0	\$0
Jupiter DEX	Free	\$0	\$0
DexScreener	Free	\$0	\$0
Binance WebSocket	Free	\$0	\$0
TradingView	Widget (Free)	\$0	\$0
CoinGecko	Free	\$0	\$0
Hosting	Vercel Free	\$0	\$0
Total		\$0/mo	\$0/day

Functional but severely rate-limited. 100K Helius credits/mo, 100 Birdeye req/day, 30 CoinGecko req/min. Good enough for development and personal use only.

TIER 2 **Small Competitor** — 100-500 daily users

SERVICE	PLAN	MONTHLY	DAILY
Helius RPC	Hacker	\$49	\$1.60
Birdeye	Starter	\$49	\$1.60
GoPlus Security	Pro	\$99	\$3.30
Jupiter DEX	Free	\$0	—
DexScreener	Free	\$0	—
Binance WebSocket	Free	\$0	—
TradingView	Widget (Free)	\$0	—
CoinGecko	Analyst	\$14	\$0.47
Hosting	Vercel Pro	\$20	\$0.67
Domain + CDN	Cloudflare	\$0	—
Total		~\$231/mo	~\$7.70/day

10M Helius credits/mo, 100K Birdeye req/mo, 500 CoinGecko req/min. Enough for a small user base with real-time data quality competitive with Axiom.

TIER 3 **Serious Competitor** — 1K-10K daily users

SERVICE	PLAN	MONTHLY	DAILY
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Helius RPC	Business	\$499	\$16.60
Birdeye	Premium	\$199	\$6.60
GoPlus Security	Enterprise	\$299	\$10.00
Jupiter DEX	Metis (Dedicated)	\$250	\$8.30
DexScreener	Paid	~\$300	~\$10.00
TradingView	Advanced Charts	~\$500	~\$16.70
CoinGecko	Pro	\$49	\$1.60
Hosting	AWS / Vercel Team	\$100	\$3.30
Database	Supabase Pro	\$25	\$0.83
Analytics	PostHog Free	\$0	—
Total		~\$2,221/mo	~\$74/day

100M Helius credits/mo, 1M Birdeye req/mo, dedicated Jupiter endpoint for fastest swap routing. Professional TradingView charting library (not just widget).

SERVICE	PLAN	MONTHLY	DAILY
Helius RPC	Enterprise	\$2,000+	~\$67
Birdeye	Enterprise	\$1,000+	~\$33
Jupiter DEX	Dedicated	\$1,000+	~\$33
Custom Solana Validator	Bare Metal	\$3,000+	~\$100
TradingView	Enterprise	\$2,000+	~\$67
Infrastructure	AWS / GCP	\$2,000+	~\$67
Engineering Team	2-4 devs	\$30,000+	~\$1,000
Total		\$40,000+/mo	\$1,300+/day

Full enterprise-grade setup with own validator node for fastest possible transaction inclusion. Requires a team and significant capital.

Where Your Money Actually Goes (Priority Order)

#	API	COST RANGE	WHY IT MATTERS
1	Helius RPC	\$49 - \$499	Fast RPC = fast trades. Free RPC = 2-5s delays. Helius = ~200ms
2	Birdeye	\$49 - \$199	Real token analytics (holders, trades, security). DexScreener free is very limited
3	GoPlus	\$0 - \$99	Rug detection. Free tier works for low volume. Critical for user trust
4	Jupiter	\$0	Free forever – they earn from aggregation fees. Best swap routing on Solana
5	CoinGecko	\$0 - \$49	Only needed for perps fallback pricing. Binance WS is primary (free)

Recommendation

Start at **Tier 2 (~\$231/mo)** with Helius Hacker + Birdeye Starter. This gives you enough API capacity for several hundred daily users with real, competitive data quality. The app already has all 6 APIs integrated and falls back gracefully when keys aren't configured. Scale to Tier 3 when you see traction — all you need to do is upgrade the API keys in your .env file.

APIs Already Integrated In Your Codebase

SERVICE	FILE	STATUS	KEY REQUIRED
Helius (RPC + DAS + Parsed Txns + WebSocket)	services/helius.ts	Ready	VITE_HELIUS_API_KEY
Birdeye (Token analytics, OHLCV, trades, security)	services/birdeye.ts	Ready	VITE_BIRDEYE_API_KEY
GoPlus (Token security audit + risk scoring)	services/goplus.ts	Ready	Optional
Jupiter (Swap quotes, execution, prices)	services/jupiter.ts	Ready	None needed
DexScreener (Token discovery, trending)	services/dexscreener.ts	Ready	None needed

Binance (WebSocket + REST for perps)	Pages/PerpetualsPage.tsx	Ready	None needed
GeckoTerminal (OHLCV candles)	services/dexscreener.ts	Ready	None needed
CoinGecko (Fallback pricing)	Pages/PerpetualsPage.tsx	Ready	Optional
Config file		.env.example — copy to .env and add keys	